

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

- The patient describes long-term sadness, hopelessness, and worsening suicidal ideations, which suggest a chronic depressive condition.

- He also mentions difficulty making decisions and concentration problems, which are common in depression.

- The patient's suicidal ideations over the past 2 weeks, along with his history of chronic depression, suggests the possibility of developing double depression.

- Mania or psychosis would manifest in different symptoms not described here.

- Anhedonia is common in depression but isn't the primary symptom being described.

- Paranoid personality disorder involves ongoing patterns of distrust and suspiciousness, not acute symptoms like the ones described.

- Given the long-standing nature of the patient's condition and the recent worsening, double depression appears to be the most fitting diagnosis from the given options.

- Double depression is characterized by the development of major depression in people with a prior history of dysthymia, which matches the patient's description of long-standing sadness and recent worsening.

- Mania and psychosis, while they can occur in bipolar disorder, are not suggested by the patient's symptoms.

- While anhedonia can occur in depression, the description suggests a broader picture of chronic and worsening depressive symptoms.

- Paranoid personality disorder is not indicated by the patient's symptoms.

- Therefore, the patient's condition best aligns with double depression.

- The patient's condition best describes the risk for double depression.

- Mania or psychosis are not suggested by the symptoms.

- Anhedonia is a symptom of depression but not the primary diagnosis.

- Paranoid personality disorder is not indicated by the patient's symptoms.

- Thus, the best statement describing the patient's condition is that he is at risk for double depression.

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<answer>A. The patient is at risk for double depression.</answer>